



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: You Shouldn't Be So Hard On Yourself.



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you find it easy or difficult to apologize to others?
- When was the last time you apologized to someone? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about feelings and sensations and encourage agreement.
- I can write about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can write rhetorical questions to encourage agreement.





Let's Explore!

Sally is listening to her favorite **station*** on the way to work.

* A "station" is a company that makes radio broadcasts.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Radio Host: Are you someone like me who apologizes for the things they have no control over? Dr. McMillan, our resident psychologist is on the line now to talk to you about what we should and should not be apologizing for.

Dr. McMillan: Thanks, Bill.

Don't you think it would be better if we weren't so hard on ourselves?

Unless you are perfect, apologies are a necessary part of life. Those two little words - "I'm sorry"- can be quite powerful. They can often make us feel better.

Apologizing helps to release guilt, doesn't it? As we all know, saying "I'm sorry" improves relationships when we have wronged, annoyed or disappointed someone. It may also restore a sense of trust between two people.

Why do some people then, apologize for things and situations outside our control like someone else's behavior? Unfortunately, excessive apologizing may make us appear to lack in confidence or competence. This could be particularly damaging in workplace environments.

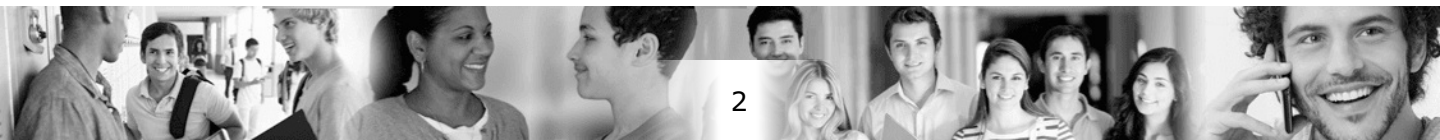
Wouldn't it be more productive to only apologize for behaviors that negatively affect other people?

Over-apologizing could be a result of our own negative mindset. Often, we are too hard on ourselves rather than recognize that everyone makes mistakes. Psychologists often suggest that we are supposed to make errors in judgement to learn social cues and expectations.

When it boils down to it - isn't it better to fight against self-criticism instead of apologizing all the time?

Radio Host: An interesting perspective, Dr. McMillan.

We're taking calls and e-mails after this commercial break. Should we be reconsidering our use of the words ... I'm sorry?





Let's Practice!

It's difficult to know what to do in some social situations!

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Use the completed sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Word Bank

often suggest / Apologizing / resident / sorry / supposed to / should / social cues / Should

1. Dr. McMillan, our _____ psychologist is on the line now to talk about what we _____ and should not be apologizing for.
2. _____ we be reconsidering our use of the words ... I'm _____?
3. Psychologists _____ that we are _____ make errors in judgement to learn _____ and expectations.
4. _____ is supposed to improve our relationships with others.



Let's Practice!

People often apologize because they feel guilty* about their behavior.

*When you feel "guilty", you feel responsible for doing something bad or wrong.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes you find. Correct the sentences.

1. Apologized helps to release, guilty, doesn't it? _____.
2. It may also restoring a sense trust between two people. _____.
3. As we all know, saying "I'm sorry" improves relationships when we have wronging, annoying or disappointed someone. _____.
4. Isn't it better to fighting against self- criticism instead of apologized all the time? _____.
5. Wouldn't it be more productive to only apologizing for behaviors that negatively affects other people? _____.
6. Doesn't you think it would be better if we wasn't so hard on ourselves? _____.





Extension Activity

You forgot your friend's birthday ... You need to apologize.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 12-14 line dialogue between you and your friend on the telephone.
- Extend an apology.
- Explain how you felt when you realized you had forgotten their birthday.
- Use the modals *may* and *might*.
- Explain what you should have done. *Example: I should have marked your birthday on the calendar.*
- Encourage agreement. *Example: I was pretty inconsiderate, wasn't I?*
- Proofread the dialogue.
- Read the dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about an apology.

☐
☐

I describe how I felt when I forgot an important celebration.

☐
☐

I write about what I should have done.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **resident** (adjective): working regularly at a particular place
e.g. Dr.McMillan, our resident psychologist is on the line now.
- **to restore** (verb): to put or bring something back into existence
e.g. It may also restore a sense of trust between two people.
- **social cues** (noun): signals people send through body language and expressions.
e.g. Psychologists often suggest that we are supposed to make errors in judgement to learn social cues.
- **mindset** (noun): a particular way of thinking
e.g. Over-apologizing could be a result of our own negative mindset.
- **self-criticism** (noun): to be critical about your own thoughts, beliefs or image
e.g. Isn't it better to fight against self-criticism?
- **commercial** (adjective): paid for by advertisers
e.g. We're taking calls after this commercial break.
- **perspective** (noun): a way of thinking about and understanding something
e.g. That's an interesting perspective, Dr.McMillan.
- **when it boils down to it** (expression): something reduced to its important parts
e.g. When it boils down to it, you apologize too much!





Learning Points

Modals For Possibility, Certainty, Suggestions and Expectations

You use modals when you want to make a guess about something. You choose different modals depending on how sure you are.

You use may, might and could to express possibility in the past and in the future.

*Might suggests that something is less possible than may

- might / might not + infinitive
- could / could not + infinitive
- may / may not + infinitive

Example:

*This **might** be the key to their apartment.*

*You **may** be able to get extra time to complete the examination.*

*This **could** be the answer to all our problems.*

Expressing Certainty

You use **must** to express that something is necessarily true.

Example: *This **must** be a mistake!*

Should, could, might and shall are used to express suggestions:

Example:

***Shouldn't** we have a get together before you head back to college?*

*You **could** talk to Richard about your problems at work.*

*You **might** consider taking the subway instead of driving.*

***Shall** we meet at the restaurant before the movie?*

Will

You use will when you are very sure.

Example: ***She'll** be at the hotel by 6PM.*

Examples:

- *It may also restore a sense of trust between two people.*
- *Excessive apologizing may make us appear to lack in confidence and competence.*
- *This could be particularly damaging in workplace environments.*





Learning Points

Negative Questions To Encourage Agreement

Negative questions have a different meaning than regular questions.

You use negative questions to confirm information you already know.

Negative questions can have two different meanings.

You can ask a negative question for confirmation of a positive belief.

You can ask a negative question for confirmation of a negative belief.

Examples:

- *Isn't it better to fight against self-criticism instead of apologizing all the time?*
- *Wouldn't it be more productive to only apologize for behaviors that negatively affect other people?*
- *Aren't they going to clean up the mess?*

